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"The great Mongol lords have villages in the south [of Crimea], from which grain and flour are brought to them for the winter. Cloth of silk, gold, and cotton reaches them from China, Persia, and other regions. From Russia and Hungary they get valuable furs.

We arrived at a large town called Qayaliq,[1] where there was a market attended by many traders. This country used to have its own language and alphabet, which were commonly used by the Nestorian Christians.[2] The country has Buddhists, Uighurs, who are Turkish Muslims, and, in the cities, Nestorian Christians and Muslims intermingled. The Mongols have adopted the alphabet used by the Uighur Muslims. They make frequent use of texts written on paper in their religious rites, and their temples are full of written prayers. I am sending you a letter from the Mongol khan that is in the Mongol language but using the Uighur alphabet."

Source: William of Rubruck, Catholic monk and missionary who was sent by the French king to the Mongol court, account of his journey through Central Asia, Circa 1255

1:city in present-day Kazakhstan, then under Mongol rule↩
2:sect of Christianity that originated in Asia Minor and spread east↩

1. The first paragraph best illustrates which of the following developments during the period 1200 to 1450?

(A) Scientific and technological advances such as paper and gunpowder spread from China.

(B) Transregional trade required a common currency throughout Afro-Eurasia.

(C) Many societies participated in expansive networks of exchange, such as the Silk Road. ✓

(D) Epidemic diseases such as the plague often spread along key trade routes.

Answer C

Correct. Rubruck notes caravans bringing silk from China, furs from Russia, and grain from Crimea, illustrating that multiple societies participated in a thriving Silk Road network that knit together distant regions between 1200 and 1450.

2. The second paragraph can best be used as evidence to support which of the following claims?

(A) The spread of empires across Eurasia contributed to the rise and fall of urban centers.

(B) Expanding commercial networks contributed to the increased production of textiles and porcelains in Afro-Eurasia.

(C) Emperors forcibly resettled rebellious tribal groups in order to centralize and maintain their power.

(D) Interactions between ethnic groups contributed to the diffusion of languages and writing systems. ✓

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Answer D

Correct. Rubruck explains that Nestorian Christians had used the language and alphabet of Qayaliq and that Mongols had used the alphabet of Uighur Muslims. Such interaction exemplifies how sustained Mongol-era trade hubs facilitated the diffusion and borrowing of languages and writing systems across Eurasian communities.

3. Which of the following was the most likely purpose of the author's visit to the region?

(A) To spread Christianity and establish diplomatic ties with the Mongols ✓
(B) To establish contracts for joint-stock companies in Central Asia
(C) To showcase the military power and international reach of the French monarchy
(D) To create diasporic communities along important regional trade routes

Answer A

Correct. Rubruck was a Catholic missionary dispatched by the French king to the Mongol court, so his journey was likely aimed at spreading Christianity and forging diplomatic ties.

Model of a Buddhist Pagoda, Painted with Bodhisattvas [Buddhist Enlightened Beings], Japan, Circa 1250

Cleveland Museum of Art. John L. Severance Fund 1982.8

Pagodas were a type of Buddhist religious structure that originated in China. Models such as this one often contained holy objects and were placed in family household shrines.

4. The image best illustrates which of the following developments in the period circa 1250 to 1400?

(A) New Buddhist states emerged in South and Southeast Asia.
(B) Regional and interregional contacts led to the diffusion of artistic traditions in Eurasia. ✓
(C) Existing overland trade routes, including the Silk Road, expanded their geographical reach.
(D) Neo-Confucianism continued to influence societies in East Asia.

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Answer B

Correct. Pagodas originated in China, so the Japanese creation of models like the example demonstrates how religious ideas and architectural designs traveled and were copied across Eurasia, illustrating the diffusion of artistic traditions in the period circa 1250 to 1400.

5. The use of objects such as the pagoda best supports which of the following conclusions about East Asian societies in the period circa 1250 to 1400?

(A) Military elites held significant power over civilian administrators.
(B) Agricultural production relied on commercialized peasant labor.
(C) Daily life was shaped by religious beliefs and practices. ✓
(D) Rulers and religious elites sometimes enforced isolationist policies.

Answer C

Correct. The caption indicates miniature pagodas often contained holy objects and were placed in household shrines, showing that everyday life was intertwined with Buddhist beliefs and ritual practices in the period 1200 to 1450.

6. The creation of objects such as the pagoda is best understood in the context of which of the following?

(A) Chinese and Indian artisans expanded the production of luxury goods for export.
(B) Many regions of Eurasia were significantly affected by Mongol conquests.
(C) Flourishing Indian Ocean trade promoted the growth of powerful states.
(D) Chinese cultural traditions influenced other East Asian societies. ✓

Answer D

Correct. Pagodas are religious structures associated with Buddhism, which originated in China. The presence of a model of a pagoda in Japan shows that Japan was influenced by Chinese cultural traditions.

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Painting of Ambon, One of the Spice Islands in the East Indies, Showing a Portuguese-Built Fortress. Commissioned by Frederik de Houtman, Dutch East India Company Governor, for the Company's Headquarters in Amsterdam, Circa 1617.

Pictures from History/Contributor/Getty Images

The Portuguese controlled trade on Ambon and the other Spice Islands until they were driven out by the Dutch in 1605.

7. The image is best understood in the context of which of the following?

(A) European states established settler colonies in their imperial territories.

(B) Trade between the Americas and Eurasia contributed to the global spread of plants and animals.

(C) Joint-stock companies contributed to the expansion of European commerce around the world. ✓

(D) European indentured laborers were often sent to work on plantations in colonies in Asia.

Answer C

Correct. The Dutch East India Company was a joint-stock enterprise whose pooled investor capital financed voyages and fortified outposts like Ambon, illustrating how stock companies fueled European commercial expansion in the 1600s.

8. Which of the following contributed most directly to the construction of the fortress depicted in the image?

(A) Growing international demand for raw materials increased the need for traditional farmworkers.

(B) Some Asian states sought to restrict the disruptive consequences of European long-distance trade networks.

(C) Increased interactions between the Eastern and Western Hemispheres contributed to religious conflicts in European colonies.

(D) Advances in navigational and maritime technologies encouraged the formation of global trading-post empires. ✓

Answer D

Correct. Navigational innovations such as accurate compasses, astrolabes, and oceangoing caravels enabled the Portuguese and Dutch to sail around Africa, reach Southeast Asia, and build permanent forts like Ambon to protect their intercontinental spice network.

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9. The presence of the Dutch on the island shown in the image was most likely a result of which of the following?

(A) The use of convict labor to support an emerging global capitalist economy

(B) Military and economic conflicts between rival empires ✓

(C) The demographic decline of Asian societies as a result of the spread of new diseases

(D) The long-distance trade in silver mined in the Americas

Answer B

Correct. The Dutch conquest of a Portuguese fortress that was used to control trade in the Spice Islands clearly illustrates both military and economic conflict between rival empires.

10. Which of the following was most likely the intended purpose for the creation of the painting?

(A) To demonstrate the power and global reach of the Dutch East India Company ✓

(B) To expand trade between the Netherlands and Portugal

(C) To warn English pirates against seizing ships and cargo in the region

(D) To illustrate the importance of migrant laborers to the colony's economy

Answer A

Correct. The detailed painting, commissioned for the Dutch East India Company's headquarters, functioned as propaganda showcasing to investors and rivals the organization's capability to dominate the lucrative trade from Ambon.

Painting Depicting Ottoman Scientists Using an Instrument to Determine Geographic Location, Constructed at the Royal Astronomical Observatory in Istanbul, 1581

G. Dagli Orti /© NPL - DeA Picture Library / Bridgeman Images

The painting was produced for an illustrated manuscript in honor of Sultan Murad III [reigned 1574 to 1595], who also commissioned the construction of the Royal Observatory.

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11. Which of the following developments during the period circa 1200 to 1450 most directly contributed to the establishment of institutions such as the one depicted in the image?

(A) Muslim states encouraged intellectual innovations and transfers across many parts of Afro-Eurasia. ✓

(B) Skilled Muslim craftsmen increased their production of luxury goods, often using technological knowledge originating in India or China.

(C) Muslim diasporic merchant communities emerged in many locations along key Afro-Eurasian trade routes.

(D) Muslim navigators' knowledge of monsoon wind patterns enabled Islamic empires to dominate trade in the Indian Ocean.

Answer A

Correct. Muslim rulers such as the Abbasids and later Ottomans created observatories, hospitals, and *madrasas* to attract scholars, encouraging the translation of Greek, Persian, and Indian texts. That state-sponsored pursuit of learning directly fostered the founding of the scientific institution shown.

12. Which of the following was the most likely purpose for including a painting of the Royal Observatory in the illustrated manuscript?

(A) To improve Ottoman government surveys of the empire's lands and population

(B) To glorify Ottoman rulers by showcasing their patronage for science and scholarship ✓

(C) To demonstrate Ottoman rulers' tolerance of non-Muslims living in the empire

(D) To illustrate the strength of the defenses of the Ottoman capital, Istanbul

Answer B

Correct. Court artists highlighted the Royal Astronomical Observatory in Istanbul to show the sultan's support for science. The inclusion of this image, showing that Sultan Murad III advanced scientific knowledge through his patronage, in a manuscript honoring the sultan indicates that glorifying Ottoman authority was the manuscript's likely purpose.

Supplemental Practice Exam MCQ

Russian Imperial Territorial Acquisitions in Asia, 1533 to 1894

The Trans-Siberian Railway network was built from 1891 to 1916.

13. Which of the following contributed most directly to the territorial changes shown on the map in the period from 1533 to 1801?

(A) A series of violent revolutions in Russia

(B) State-imposed restrictions of ethnic and religious diversity

(C) Consolidation of state power and the growth of the military ✓

(D) Industrialization of the Russian empire

Answer C

Correct. Russia's expansion in the period portrayed on the map can be attributed to military growth and the use of new technologies such as gunpowder weapons and tactics designed to centralize state power, such as the use of bureaucratic elites and innovations in tax collection.

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14. Projects such as the Trans-Siberian Railway can best be understood in the context of which of the following?

(A) Some states financed modernization and industrialization efforts. ✓

(B) New economic inequalities caused widespread calls for reforms.

(C) Some states limited their international trade to protect their local economies.

(D) The Second Industrial Revolution led to improved living conditions for peasants.

Answer A

Correct. The expansive Trans-Siberian Railway exemplifies how some states bankrolled industrial and infrastructure schemes to modernize and compete during the late-nineteenth and early-twentieth centuries.

15. The construction of the Trans-Siberian Railway most likely had which effect on the cities along its route?

(A) Large populations moved from these cities to rural areas.

(B) Railway construction demolished large portions of the historical centers of these cities.

(C) Most of these cities experienced rapid population growth. ✓

(D) Industrial manufacturers relocated from these cities to major population centers such as Moscow.

Answer C

Correct. The line connected remote settlements to the eastern capital of Moscow, spurring trade and jobs, resulting in significant population growth.

"We, a community of Black slaves, residents in this country, petition your Lordship to say that the love of freedom is natural in every creature, and in us is even stronger, as our captivity and the work we perform are very painful.

We ask that every slave who is actively employed should contribute one or two *realsSpanish unit of currency* every day to an emancipation fund. As soon as enough money has been collected, the Court should immediately apply it to purchase the freedom of one or more of the most needy slaves in our community. In this way, your Lordship could free two or three slaves each month."

Source: Petition by enslaved persons to the Spanish governor of Guayaquil, present-day Ecuador, 1822

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16. The petitioners' argument in the first paragraph best illustrates which of the following eighteenth- and nineteenth-century ideas?

(A) Socialist ideas that revolutionary class conflict shaped the development of societies
(B) The idea that colonizers had a duty to bring civilization to their subjects
(C) Nationalist ideas that people who share a language and culture should be self-governing
(D) Enlightenment ideas that emphasized liberty and individual rights ✓

Answer D

Correct. The petitioners' argument that "love of freedom is natural in every creature" reflects Enlightenment ideas of individual and natural rights.

17. Which of the following most significantly transformed the historical situation in Latin America during the period circa 1800 to 1830?

(A) Mechanized factory production expanded in many countries.
(B) Many societies achieved national independence. ✓
(C) Silver from the Americas enriched European economies.
(D) Spain and Portugal competed for control of territory in South America.

Answer B

Correct. In this period Latin American independence movements contested Spanish and Portuguese rule, replacing colonial administrations with sovereign republics across most of Latin America.

18. The passage best illustrates that enslaved persons in the Americas sought to advance their rights by engaging in which of the following?

(A) Appealing to the legal system to bring about social change ✓
(B) Organizing armed rebellions against colonial authorities
(C) Encouraging other enslaved persons to run away and form maroon communities
(D) Sabotaging plantation machinery to halt production

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Answer A

Correct. By drafting a formal petition to the Spanish governor and promising to fund the purchase of freedom, the enslaved community used recognized legal channels and the colonial bureaucracy to advance freedom, showing how some enslaved persons pursued emancipation through the courts.

"Recently, Muslims have started to diverge from some of the principles of Islamic law. One example relates to the education and upbringing of women. Some Muslims now argue that God's will is for women to be married and raise children and, therefore, educating them prevents them from fulfilling their rightful responsibilities. This is absolutely an ignorant position to take and it violates God's will. Our young girls who attend primary and secondary schools are more able to fulfill God's will than those who do not.

What [these critics] do not understand is the fact that God wills both men and women to develop their minds, to be educated, and to learn science and other forms of knowledge. The daughters of all Muslims in Russia must be educated, just like our sons."

Source: Ismail Gasprinsky, Russian Muslim from the Tatar ethnic group and an advocate for modernization in the Russian Empire, summary of his ideas as printed in his obituary, 1914

19. Which of the following is an argument made in the passage?

(A) Men and women should have professional equality.

(B) Women and girls should have access to education. ✓

(C) Women should not have voting rights.

(D) Women should not study Islamic law.

Answer B

Correct. Gasprinsky insists that women should be educated just like men, making the need for female education the central argument of the passage.

20. The passage is best understood in the context of which of the following in the period after 1850?

(A) Armed rebellions by minorities against colonial authorities

(B) Conflicts between different ethnic minority groups

(C) Ongoing debates about social reforms ✓

(D) Formation of international organizations to protect human rights

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Answer C

Correct. Across Eurasia after 1850, reformers debated education, women's rights, and modernization within empires; Gasprinsky's call to educate daughters fits these ongoing discussions of social reform.

21. Based on the passage, Gasprinsky most likely believed that

(A) Islamic traditions should be rejected in order to secularize Muslim communities

(B) other religions are superior to Islam because they allow for more gender equality

(C) the true teachings of Islam support his argument about education ✓

(D) Islamic tradition requires that women should focus entirely on raising children

Answer C

Correct. Gasprinsky references his belief that it is "God's will," and thus the true intent of Islamic law, that women should be educated.

"Africa was the last region to break the bondage of colonialism. It was not until [after] World War II that most African countries achieved independence.... Many African countries became pawns in the Cold War's division of the world, and social and economic development took second place to issues related to national security policies of Western countries.

Africa's boundaries were drawn arbitrarily at the Berlin Conference of 1884–85 when Great Britain, France, Belgium, Italy, Portugal, Germany, and Spain [ignored] a thousand indigenous cultures and superimposed a new map that supported the economic desires of the imperial powers. Colonial powers were interested in extracting resources, not building schools, infrastructure and public institutions. Often, colonial leaders treated their 'subjects' as subhuman."

Source: Margee Ensign and William Bertrand, United States historians of Africa, *Rwanda: History and Hope*, 2010

22. The events described in the first paragraph were part of which of the following broader historical processes?

(A) After the Second World War, the United States assisted many nations with their rebuilding efforts.

(B) Many former European colonies achieved self-government either peacefully or through armed resistance. ✓

(C) The Soviet Union implemented oppressive policies to exert greater control over its population.

(D) Improvements in transportation and communication technologies contributed to the globalization of the world economy.

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Answer B

Correct. The authors note Africa was "the last region to break the bond of colonialism," referring to the wave of post-1945 decolonization that dismantled European empires across the continent.

23. Which of the following is an argument made by the authors in the first paragraph regarding the Cold War?

(A) Many countries joined the Non-Aligned Movement to avoid making alliances with the superpowers.

(B) The United States and the Soviet Union attempted to expand their empires by conquering territories in Africa.

(C) Global competition between the superpowers interfered with the advancement of newly independent countries in Africa. ✓

(D) The proliferation of nuclear weapons threatened the existence of African countries.

Answer C

Correct. The authors contend Western governments prioritized Cold-War security over African economic and social development.

24. As described in the second paragraph, the Berlin Conference was part of which of the following processes in the late nineteenth century?

(A) Various European nations utilized military force and diplomacy to enlarge their colonial empires. ✓

(B) As industrial capitalism expanded, it increased the availability and variety of consumer goods.

(C) Religious ideas and nationalism sparked rebellions against imperial rule in Afro-Eurasia.

(D) Some countries restricted the flow of immigrants because of ethnic and racial prejudice.

Answer A

Correct. The second paragraph describes arbitrary African borders set by European nations at the Berlin Conference.

25. The authors' assessment in the second paragraph that colonial leaders treated their subject peoples as "subhuman" most directly reflects which of the following shifts in the late twentieth century?

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(A) Economic and political instability contributed to dramatic increases in the number of refugees worldwide.

(B) International organizations formed in order to prevent conflicts among countries.

(C) The arts became more reflective of various criticisms against social and political inequities.

(D) New scholarship rejected earlier assumptions about Western superiority and racial hierarchies. ✓

Answer D

Correct. By addressing how colonial leaders viewed their "subjects," the authors evoke late-twentieth-century human-rights discourse that condemned racial oppression and promoted universal dignity.

"Sailing with a north wind for twenty days from the island of Sumatra, one arrives at the country of Sri Lanka in the Indian Ocean.

The king of this country lives in a palace decorated with many kinds of precious stones. The palace has eastern and western halls, in each of which stands a golden tree. The trunk and branches are all made of gold, while the flowers, fruits, and leaves are blue and red jewels.

This land produces red glass, blue and red jewels, cardamom spice, and fine aromatic oils. Chinese merchants passing through can sell sandalwood, cloves, gold, silver, porcelain ware, horses, elephants, and silk."

Source: Zhao Rukuo, Chinese historian and Song dynasty official, overseer of maritime trade on the southeastern coast of China, from his book *Records of Foreign People*, based on interviews with maritime merchants, Circa 1225

26. The first sentence of the passage best illustrates which of the following during the period circa 1200 to 1450?

(A) Knowledge of regional weather patterns, such as monsoon winds, facilitated maritime travel. ✓

(B) Gunpowder weapons contributed to expanded conflicts in the Indian Ocean.

(C) Long-distance travelers published written accounts of their journeys.

(D) A wide range of staple crops and bulk goods were exchanged between coastal ports.

Answer A

Correct. Zhao reports that ships leave Sumatra and, with a steady north wind, reach China in only twenty days, providing evidence that sailors timed departures around predictable wind patterns.

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27. The passage is best understood in the context of which of the following in the period circa 1200 to 1450?

(A) The expansion of the Mongol Empire directly linked the regions of East, Central, and Western Asia.

(B) Increased mobility across Eurasia contributed to the spread of epidemic diseases.

(C) Foreign demand for luxury goods contributed to the expansion of Chinese trade and manufacturing. ✓

(D) Hinduism and Buddhism continued to influence societies and states in South and Southeast Asia.

Answer C

Correct. Zhao emphasizes Sri Lankan production of jewels, spices and oils while also noting the ability of Chinese merchants to sell a wide variety of luxury goods. His notes on fast sailing times and profitable cargoes reveal how foreign appetite for luxury goods spurred Song officials and merchants to expand production and maritime commerce.

28. All of the following statements are factually accurate. Which would most directly prompt a historian to question the accuracy of Zhao Rukuo's geographic knowledge?

(A) Zhao was a member of the Song royal family, descended from Emperor Taizong.

(B) Zhao held a variety of positions in the Song bureaucracy for more than 30 years.

(C) Zhao lived in Song China and did not travel outside of its borders. ✓

(D) Zhao's written works described many kingdoms that had economic relations with China.

Answer C

Correct. Because Zhao never left China, his detailed comments about distant kingdoms rested entirely on information from other individuals. This would prompt historians to question how accurately second-hand merchant tales captured local realities.

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Tiled Panel in the Garden District of Isfahan, a Park Built During the Reign of the Safavid Shah Abbas I [Reigned 1588 to 1629], Circa 1620

Rogers Fund, 1903

Next to the Persian woman in the center is a male figure in a European cloak and hat, likely a merchant showing samples of cloth to her.

29. The creation of works such as the tiled panel is best understood in the context of which of the following?

(A) In many Islamic cultures, artists avoided the depiction of human and animal figures for religious reasons.

(B) Rulers of land-based empires used increased tax revenues to commission art and architecture. ✓

(C) Land-based empires encouraged the mass immigration of diverse populations to foster the development of commerce.

(D) In some regions of Asia, peasants increased their production of staple crops as a result of the adoption of new agricultural techniques.

Answer B

Correct. Rulers of land-based empires like the Safavid shahs used innovative methods of tax collection to finance lavish building programs such as the garden district park. Commissioning finely painted tile panels for palaces and parks was a display of power.

30. A historian may use the image as evidence for which of the following claims about Safavid Iran?

(A) It had a series of military conflicts with the Ottoman Empire.

(B) It had significant long-distance trade contacts with other regions. ✓

(C) It integrated gunpowder weapons into its army.

(D) Its architecture was characterized by distinctive domes.

Answer B

Correct. The seated cloth merchant’s broad-brimmed European hat reveals that Isfahan's workshops drew on imported fashions and goods, evidencing the Safavid capital's extensive long-distance trade links.

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31. Based on the image, it can be inferred that in the period circa 1450 to 1750, in some Islamic societies

(A) men and women interacted in public spaces ✓

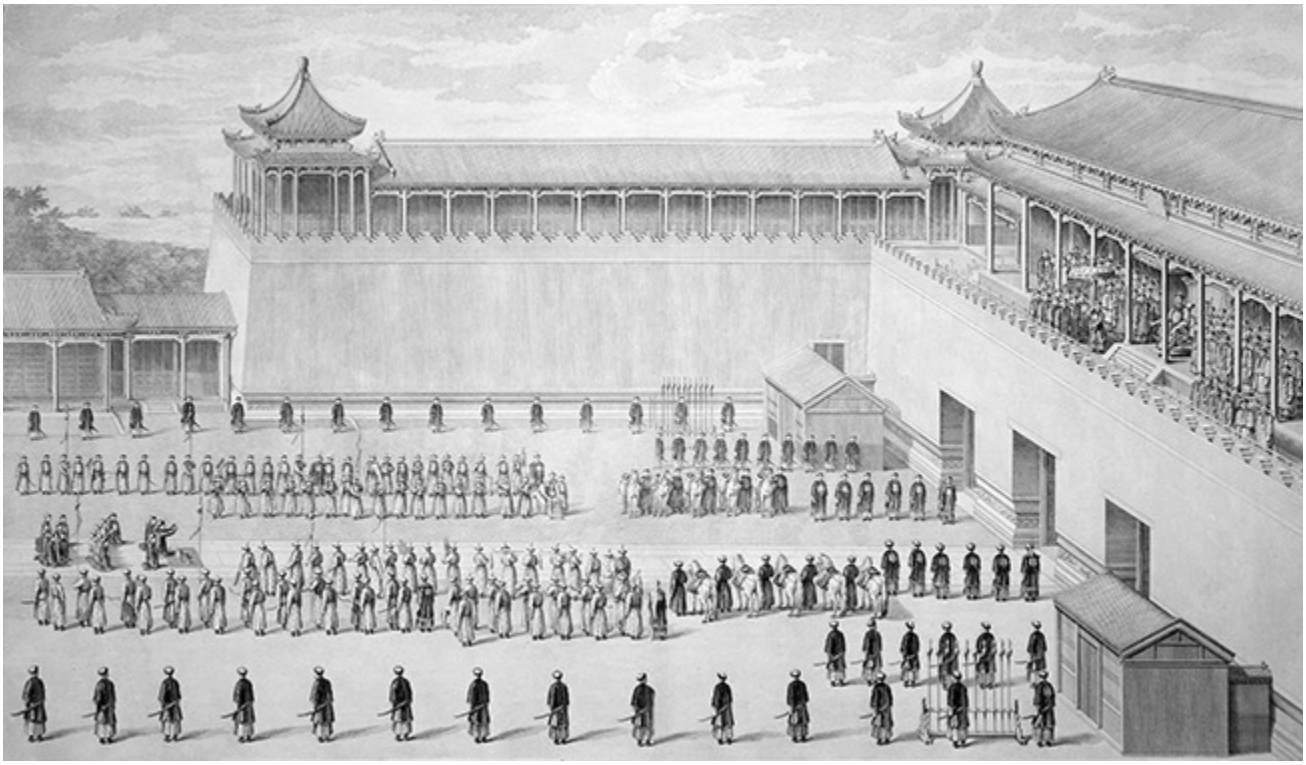
(B) elite women were given access to the same type of education as men

(C) women achieved full equality with men

(D) women were only permitted to be around their male relatives

Answer A

Correct. In the image, men and women interact together in a public garden pavilion, indicating that some Islamic courts permitted mixed-gender social interaction.



Engraving Commissioned by the Emperor of the Qing Dynasty to Commemorate the Qing Destruction of the Mongol Zunghar Khanate, Printed in Paris, Circa 1760

Harris Brisbane Dick Fund, 1945

The image depicts prisoners captured during the Zunghar campaign.

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32. The emperor most likely commissioned the print in order to

(A) reverse European military invasions of his territories

(B) modernize his military technologies and tactics

(C) legitimize his rule by demonstrating his military success ✓

(D) show his tolerance to various ethnic and religious groups

Answer C

Correct. The Mongol prisoners depicted in front of an elevated Qing royal audience would have served as proof of the Qing Emperor's military success and therefore the legitimacy of his rule.

33. The image best illustrates which of the following developments in the period circa 1600 to 1800?

(A) The Qing dynasty took control of China and expanded its territory through conquests. ✓

(B) The Qing Empire collapsed under external pressure and failure to conduct reforms.

(C) Qing China introduced restrictive policies against Han Chinese people.

(D) Qing emperors were challenged by established bureaucratic elites.

Answer A

Correct. The depiction of Mongol prisoners highlights the Qing dynasty's success in expanding through military conquest.

34. The development shown in the image represents a significant change from which of the following in the earlier period circa 1200 to 1450?

(A) The Chinese economy flourished due to innovations in agriculture and manufacturing.

(B) Mongol khanates dominated politics and trade across Eurasia. ✓

(C) The beliefs and practices of Confucianism defined Chinese governance.

(D) Many ethnic groups across Afro-Eurasia adopted Islamic practices.

Answer B

Correct. In the period 1200 to 1450, Mongol khanates dominated Eurasian politics and trade, so the

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destruction of a Mongol khanate by Chinese forces represents a significant change.

35. The emperor's decision to have the image engraved and printed outside of China best illustrates which of the following developments?

(A) Trade and other contacts between various societies in Afro-Eurasia encouraged cultural transfers. ✓

(B) Some Asian countries adopted isolationist diplomatic and trade policies.

(C) New manufacturing methods in Europe had increased the availability of many consumer goods.

(D) Connections between the hemispheres led to significant demographic changes.

Answer A

Correct. The use of French engraving to produce this commemorative image indicates cultural transfer between China and Europe due to trade and other contacts.

"After the period of intense armed activity that sub-Saharan Africa has been through in recent times, it would be opportune to stop for a while in order to pacify and organize the newly conquered territories.

If Captain Voulet[1] were to proceed further with his troops, he would come under attack as soon as he left the territories under our control. And even within our territories, assembling a convoy of 800 porters[2] to support a further military advance would cause deep trouble across the land. Recruiting porters would be difficult and feeding them would be nearly impossible. They would be driven by hunger to steal and raid the villages and [Voulet] would have to use violence."

Source: Jean-Baptiste Chaudié, governor-general of French West Africa, letter to the Minister of Colonies regarding military activities, 1898

1:commander of a French expedition in West Africa↩
2:Local inhabitants were commonly forced into service by the military to carry supplies.↩

36. The passage best illustrates which of the following developments in the period 1750 to 1900?

(A) Industrializing nations in western Europe started replacing mercantilism with free trade policies.

(B) European countries waged war against local African populations in order to enlarge their colonial empires. ✓

(C) Efforts to enslave people and transport them across the Atlantic disrupted many African societies.

(D) Enlightenment ideas led to the growth of movements protesting inequalities in imperial states.

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Answer B

Correct. The reference to a "period of intense armed activity" in sub-Saharan Africa and discussion of difficulties related to supporting military advances relate to European attempts to enlarge colonial empires in Africa through military conquest.

37. The potential difficulties with Captain Voulet's expedition discussed in the passage best support which of the following conclusions?

(A) Many Africans had embraced the European principles of natural rights and self-determination.
(B) European colonial officials modernized the economies of African regions under their control.
(C) Tropical diseases hindered European colonial expansion in sub-Saharan Africa.
(D) African resistance was a significant factor influencing European colonial authorities' decisions. ✓

Answer D

Correct. Because, as the letter notes, the French captain would "come under attack as soon as he left the territories under our control," African resistance was a difficulty that shaped military decisions by the French government.

38. Territorial conquests in Africa, such as the ones referred to in the passage, were a result of which of the following sentiments in Europe in the period circa 1880 to 1914?

(A) Criticisms of the way European colonial officials treated Africans
(B) Intense nationalism and a desire to outdo imperial rivals ✓
(C) Fears that Europe would become the destination for large numbers of economic migrants from Africa
(D) Concerns about the costs of maintaining an empire and calls to abandon the colonies

Answer B

Correct. Nationalism was one of many justifications for European imperialism in Africa, along with Social Darwinism, the concept of the civilizing mission, and the desire to convert indigenous populations.

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39. The accumulated effects of European actions such as those discussed in the passage most directly led many Africans in the twentieth century to

(A) support military coups that overthrew African countries' democratic institutions

(B) join the Non-Aligned Movement

(C) seek independence from foreign rule ✓

(D) emigrate to Europe in search of new work opportunities

Answer C

Correct. Following World War II, many Africans challenged colonial rule and achieved independence.

"The Iwakura Mission[1] brought back much information from America relating to government rules and organization. Based on this, I recommended a thorough restructuring of government offices, starting with our finance ministry. My recommendations were eventually adopted.

My next assignment was to study banking regulations. We needed a new banking system to support our commerce and industry so we could become a rich nation.

To further develop commerce and industry, we needed small firms to be incorporated into larger ones. As to the laws governing incorporation, I thought about them while studying in France. After my return from France, I organized a local commercial association in Shizuoka to serve as a model for incorporation in our country.

In the early years of Meiji, the government also encouraged the creation of state-run companies. The government actively participated in these companies' affairs and saw to it that their various needs were met."

Source: Eiichi Shibusawa, Japanese government official, industrialist, and founder of the First National Bank of Japan, autobiography, published in 1873

1:an 1871 to 1873 Japanese government-sponsored voyage to Europe and the United States to study the political, industrial, military, and educational systems of Western nations↩

40. The passage could best be used as evidence of which of the following developments in Japan during the period 1750 to 1900?

(A) Traditional political elites and the samurai class lost power.

(B) Working-class women helped support their families by working in factories.

(C) European states sometimes created settler colonies in regions under their control.

(D) Contact with Western nations influenced industrial reforms. ✓

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Answer D

Correct. Shibusawa recounts how the Iwakura Mission gathered Western models and how the government founded banks and pilot companies based on the results of that mission, showing foreign contact directly drove Japan's industrial reforms.

41. The second and third paragraphs are best understood in the context of which of the following in the period 1750 to 1900?

(A) Innovations in business organization and finance ✓
(B) The need for new types of natural resources to sustain industrialization
(C) The outsourcing of industrial production to East Asia
(D) The emergence of ideologies opposing global capitalism

Answer A

Correct. The recognition that Japan needed a new banking system and that small firms needed to be converted into larger ones clearly demonstrates innovation in business organization and finance.

42. Which of the following countries was most similar to Japan in both industrializing relatively late in the nineteenth century and having a high level of government involvement in the industrialization process?

(A) India
(B) Russia ✓
(C) Great Britain
(D) The Netherlands

Answer B

Correct. Like Japan, Russia industrialized late in the nineteenth century, adopting methods of industrial production and modes of government involvement based on models from northwestern Europe.

43. The developments in Japan, such as those described in the passage, contributed most directly to which of the following changes in East Asia during the first half of the twentieth century?

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(A) The spread of communist ideology in Japan
(B) Increasing intrusions by Western powers into Asian markets
(C) The growing involvement of international organizations to maintain peace
(D) Japanese colonization in Asia to secure raw materials ✓

Answer D

Correct. Japan acquired territories throughout Asia to support the industries that grew as a result of the developments referenced in the passage.

Total Number of Troops Employed in British India, From a British Statistical Report, Prepared in 1867

Year	European Troops (regular British Army forces and East India Company forces)	Indian Troops (East India Company forces before 1858; regular British Army forces after 1858)	Total
1856	45,104	225,221	270,325
1857	45,522	232,224	277,746
1858	*(records destroyed)*	*(records destroyed)*	*(records destroyed)*
1859	106,290	196,243	302,533
1860	92,866	213,002	305,868

The records for 1858 were destroyed during the Indian Rebellion, an uprising started by Indian troops employed by the East India Company and later joined by some local Indian rulers.

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44. Which of the following was most likely the intended audience for the table?

(A) Indian merchants who exported cotton to Great Britain

(B) British religious leaders who coordinated missionary efforts to India

(C) British officials who administered imperial territories ✓

(D) European plantation owners who recruited laborers

Answer C

Correct. Detailed year-by-year tallies of British and Indian troops around the time of the Indian Rebellion would have helped British colonial administrators and War Office planners manage garrisons and budgets.

45. Which of the following developments best provides context for the change in the number of European troops in British India from 1857 to 1859?

(A) Social Darwinism contributed to the development of imperialism in Afro-Eurasia.

(B) Europeans established settler colonies in some parts of their empires.

(C) Local resistance against colonizers significantly disrupted imperial rule. ✓

(D) Export economies based on the extraction of raw materials grew around the world.

Answer C

Correct. The Indian Rebellion forced Britain to reinforce garrisons with tens of thousands of regular soldiers, producing the sharp rise in European troop numbers shown for 1859, while the number of Indian troops declined significantly.

46. Which of the following twentieth-century developments most directly changed the political situation shown in the table?

(A) The British victory in the First World War

(B) Fascism

(C) The Bolshevik Revolution in Russia

(D) Decolonization ✓

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Answer D

Correct. Amid a broader wave of decolonization after World War II, India gained independence from Great Britain, ending the imperial political structure implied by the troop table.

Source 1

"I assume that you, like any other sane man in this nuclear age, would not want to deliberately plunge the world into war, which could only result in catastrophic consequences to the whole world, including the aggressor.

At our [meetings], I made clear that because of the ideology to which you adhere, the United States could not tolerate any action on your part which in a major way disturbed the existing balance of power in the world.

I stated that if certain developments in Cuba[1] took place, the United States would do whatever must be done to protect its own security and that of its allies. Despite this, the rapid deployment of [Soviet] long-range missiles in Cuba has proceeded."

Source: Letter from United States President John F. Kennedy to Soviet leader Nikita Khrushchev, October 22, 1962

Source 2

"I assure you that your conclusions regarding offensive weapons on Cuba are groundless. We have differences on ideological questions. But these must be solved on the basis of peaceful competition. The continued peaceful coexistence of the two different social-political systems now existing in the world is necessary to assure a stable peace.

We have received proposals [to avoid war] from the Acting Secretary General of the UN; I consider these proposals reasonable. You and I understand perfectly what terrible forces our countries possess."

Source: Response from Khrushchev to Kennedy, October 26, 1962

1:In October 1962, the United States and the Soviet Union became involved in the Cuban missile crisis, caused by Soviet efforts to install nuclear missiles in Cuba.↩

47. The two sources best support which of the following claims?

(A) The Soviet Union planned to establish settler colonies on the island of Cuba.

(B) Both the United States and the Soviet Union attempted to join the Non-Aligned Movement.

(C) The Cold War superpowers were engaged in a power struggle involving postcolonial states. ✓

(D) The Soviet Union never placed any long-range missiles on Cuba's territory.

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Answer C

Correct. The reference to "the existing balance of power in the world" along with the debate about Soviet ability to influence Cuba found in the sources indicates the United States and Soviet Union were engaged in a power struggle involving postcolonial states such as Cuba.

48. Which of the following best represents a point of view shared by both leaders?

(A) The United States should be able to place missiles on Cuba.

(B) Nuclear war would be devastating to both the Soviet Union and the United States. ✓

(C) Nuclear war between the Cold War superpowers was inevitable.

(D) A war would not affect the civilian populations of either the United States or the Soviet Union.

Answer B

Correct. Kennedy's discussion of war in the first paragraph of Source 1, along with Khrushchev's reference to the "terrible forces our countries possess," show that both sides were aware of the consequences of nuclear war.

49. Kennedy's reference in Source 1 to the United States needing to protect "its own security and that of its allies" can be best understood in the context of which of the following?

(A) NAFTA was created as a free trade zone for Mexico, Canada, and the United States.

(B) During the Second World War, the United States joined an alliance against Nazi Germany.

(C) The Warsaw Pact included several of the Eastern and central European socialist states.

(D) During the Cold War, NATO policies were focused on the threats posed by the Soviet Union. ✓

Answer D

Correct. The United States and its allies were concerned with limiting the threats posed by the Soviet Union and the United States was a member of NATO when these letters were exchanged between Kennedy and Khrushchev.

50. The "two different social-political systems" referenced by Khrushchev in Source 2 were

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(A) national socialism and constitutional monarchy

(B) democratic capitalism and communism ✓

(C) fascism and imperialism

(D) military dictatorship and theocratic republic

Answer B

Correct. The democracy of the United States and its allies and the communism of the Soviet Union and its allies were the two dominant social-political systems of the Cold War.

51. Expensive military competition and proxy conflicts between the superpowers, such as the one referenced in the sources, contributed most directly to which of the following in the late twentieth century?

(A) The collapse of the Soviet Union ✓

(B) The rise of communism in Latin America

(C) The establishment of the United Nations

(D) The increasing isolationism of the United States

Answer A

Correct. The Soviet Union's collapse can be attributed to costly wars and lack of success in proxy conflicts with the United States and its allies.

Striking Sales Workers Occupy Galeries Lafayette, a Department Store in Paris, France, 1936

© SZ Photo / Scherl / Bridgeman Images

After the election of the Popular Front [a coalition led by socialist parties] to the national government in France in May 1936, a nationwide strike in June resulted in a new labor law that guaranteed workers the right to strike, collective bargaining rights, wage increases, and a 40-hour workweek.

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52. Which of the following nineteenth-century developments contributed most directly to events like the one portrayed in the image?

(A) Revolutionary movements applied Enlightenment ideas to establish independent states.

(B) Migrant workers relocated from colonized territories to metropoles.

(C) Industrial workers organized themselves politically to seek improved working conditions. ✓

(D) Western corporations outsourced production to reduce their labor costs.

Answer C

Correct. In industrialized states, workers' movements organized and engaged in actions designed to improve working conditions, limit hours, and gain higher wages.

53. The image best illustrates which of the following developments?

(A) Workers in communist societies established collectives and cooperatives to run formerly capitalist businesses.

(B) Middle-class women were often limited to domestic roles in households and families.

(C) Minority ethnic or religious groups sought constitutional protections for their communities.

(D) Women participated in movements that advocated for greater economic and social equality. ✓

Answer D

Correct. The presence of so many women among the striking workers illustrates how women participated in movements that advocated for greater equality.

54. Which of the following developments in the early twentieth century most likely contributed to increased worker discontent and protest movements?

(A) The expansion of women's suffrage

(B) The Great Depression ✓

(C) The creation of the League of Nations

(D) The emergence of fascism

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Answer B

Correct. The global economic crisis engendered by the Great Depression likely caused conditions that provoked both worker discontent and protests.

55. The methods used by the striking workers shown in the image were most similar to the methods used by which of the following?

(A) Communist movements whose leaders nationalized large businesses and redistributed economic resources

(B) Civil rights movements whose leaders used nonviolent protests to bring about political change ✓

(C) Totalitarian governments whose leaders used repression or genocide against various social, economic, or ethnic groups

(D) Military groups whose leaders staged coups and rebellions to seize power in their countries

Answer B

Correct. The strikers are presented as nonviolent protesters whose goals related to enacting political and economic changes.